

ANNUAL REPORT

FOR THE FINANCIAL YEAR 2025-26

INTRODUCTION:

Overview: -

School of Geographical Studies (SGS) came in to existence vide Bihar Government Notification No. - 15/P 5-09/2016 अंश -193, Dated- 09.02.2018 as an Autonomous Institute, affiliated to Aryabhata Knowledge University. However, vide Bihar Government Notification No. – 15/M 1-69/2021 – 1997, dated – September 20th, 2021, School of Geographical Studies is now a constituent unit of the Aryabhata Knowledge University.

The School aims to become a premier and prestigious Institute of Geographical Studies in the Bihar Region. The growing need of quality education in the field of Geographical Studies and research led the Government of Bihar to establish the School of Geographical Studies as an Institution of Higher Learning.

The basic objectives behind establishing the School are Teaching, Training and undertaking Research in the areas of Geographical Studies. The first enrollment for Ph.D. in Geography took place in the session 2020-21 and the second was in the session 2021-22.

The first batch of M.A/M.Sc. in Geography was commenced in 2022. On the other hand, M.Sc. in GIS and Remote Sensing, PG Diploma and Certificate Courses in GIS and Remote Sensing Courses will star in the foreseeable future, once the regular teaching posts are engaged.

Mission: -

- To build intellectual, creative, and practical abilities of the Institution and Students.
- To recruit and retain outstanding faculty to foster the advancement of developmental vision and mentoring emerging scholars to realize their highest potential and assume roles of leadership, responsibility and service to society.
- To create a wealth of Knowledge through rigorous research work and make vital publications.

Vision: -

The School of Geographical Studies will be a cornerstone of learning and of academic excellence. It will be the destination of choice for meritorious students. This will be achieved by promoting active learning and inquiry.

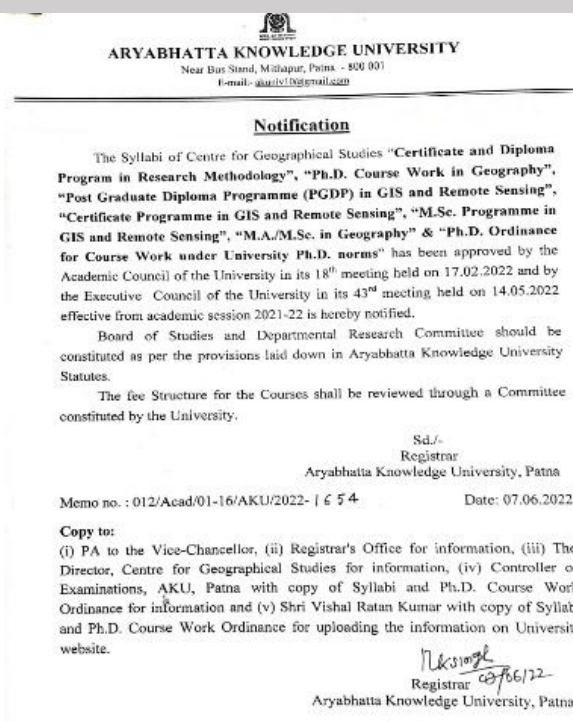
INSTITUTIONAL HIGHLIGHTS:

Courses on offer: -

The 18th Academic Council held on 17.02.2022, approved the following courses for the School of Geographical Studies: -

1. Ph.D. in Geography
2. Post Graduate Diploma Programme (PGDP) in GIS & Remote Sensing
3. M.Sc. Programme in GIS remote Sensing
4. M.A. in Geography

At present, Ph.D. Programme and M.A./M.Sc. in Geography are two undergoing courses at the School of Geographical Studie. There are currently eight Research Scholars pursuing research at the School. And the course of M.A./M.Sc. is running for Session 2024-2026 and Session 2025-27.



ACADEMIC PERFORMANCES:

Teachers at the School of Geographical Studies: -

In addition to a regular Assistant Professor, Dr. Manish Parashar, three Guest faculties have been appointed at the School of Geographical Studies vide Memo No. 003/Admn/02.53/AKU/2025 – 3007, Dated: 19.06.2025. LIST OF TEACHERS

S.NO.	NAME OF THE TEACHER	DESIGNATION
1	Dr. Manish Parashar	Asst. Professor cum Head of School of Geographical Studies
2	Dr. Angad Yadav	Guest Faculty
3	Dr. Dayanand Kumar	Guest Faculty
4	Dr. Rabindra Paswan	Guest Faculty

Enrollment of Students: -

There are 20 students in semester IV session (2024-2026). A total of 33 students have been successfully enrolled in the Master of Arts (M.A.) program in Geography for the academic session 2025-27. These students will undertake a structured curriculum designed to enhance their understanding of geographical concepts, research methodologies, and applied geography. The program spans two years, covering various aspects such as physical geography, human geography, cartography, environmental studies, and geospatial technologies. Their enrolment signifies their commitment to pursuing higher education in this field, preparing them for academic research, policy-making, and career opportunities in geography-related domains.

Classes and Exams: -

- 1st Semester classes of M.A./M.Sc. in Geography, Session 2025-27 were conducted from 18.08.2025 to 31.01.2026 and two Mid Semester Exams were also conducted during the same period.
- 2nd Semester classes of M.A. in Geography, Session 2025-27 were conducted from 09.03.2026 to till date and first Mid Semester Exams were also conducted during the same period.
- 3rd Semester classes of M.A./M.Sc. in Geography, Session 2024-26 were conducted from 01.01.2026 to 09.03.2026 and two Mid Semester Exams were also conducted during the same period.
- 4th Semester classes of M.A. in Geography, Session 2024-26 were conducted from 18.03.2026 to till date and first Mid Semester Exams were also conducted during the same period

Research Papers: -

1. Dr. Manish Parashar, Assistant Professor, School of Geographical Studies published his Research Paper in **INTERNATIONAL JOURNAL OF RESEARCH AND ANALYTICAL REVIEWS**, titled – “**Understanding air Pollution in Bihar: A District-Level Analysis of causes, Effects, and Mitigation Strategies**”.



2. Ph.D. Research Scholar, Sarita Kumari published her Research Paper under the supervision of Dr. Manish Parashar, Assistant Professor, School of Geographical Studies:

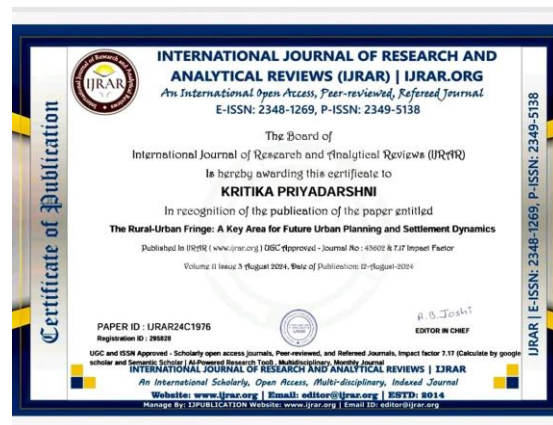
- i. Her Research Paper, “असंगठित क्षेत्र में घरेलू महिला कामगारों की आर्थिक स्थिति का विश्लेषणात्मक अध्ययन”, was published online in www.universitypublication.in, INSIGHT: AN INTERNATIONAL MULTILINGUAL JOURNAL FOR ARTS AND HUMANITIES.



- ii. Her 2nd Paper was published in AGPE THE ROYAL GONDWANA RESEARCH JOURNAL OF HISTORY, SCIENCE, ECONOMIC, POLITICAL AND SOCIAL SCIENCE, titled – “प्रवास और घरेलू महिला श्रमिक पर इसका प्रभाव”.



3. Ph.D. Research Scholar, Kritika Priyadarshni published her Research Paper under the supervision of Dr. Manish Parashar, Assistant Professor, School of Geographical Studies, Aryabhatta Knowledge University, Patan in INTERNATIONAL JOURNAL OF RESEARCH AND ANALYTICAL REVIEWS. The title of her Research Paper was – “The Rural Urban Fringe: A Key Area for Future Urban Planning and Settlement Dynamics”



4. Ph.D. Research Scholar, Mr. Vishwanath Prasad published his Research Paper entitled “Towards Sustainable Urban Futures: A Comprehensive Study on Solid Waste Management in India” under the supervision of Dr. Manish Parashar, Assistant Professor, School of Geographical Studies, Aryabhatta Knowledge University, Patan in INTERNATIONAL JOURNAL OF RESEARCH AND ANALYTICAL REVIEWS.



5. Ph.D. Research Scholar, Mr. Saurav Kumar published his research paper entitled **“Navigating Hurdles in the Development of Smart Cities: Insights from India”** under the supervision of Dr. Manish Parashar, Assistant Professor, School of Geographical Studies in **INTERNATIONAL JOURNAL OF RESEARCH AND ANALYTICAL REVIEWS**.
6. Dr. Dayanand Kumar, Guest Faculty published his research paper entitled **“Examining the Relationship Between Female Labour Force Participation and Crime Rates Against Women in India: A Cross-Regional Empirical Analysis”** in International Journal of Science and Research.



8th Departmental Research Committee/Board of Studies (DRC/BOS): -

The 8th meeting of the Departmental Research Committee (DRC) was held in the Department/School under the chairmanship of the Head of the Department to discuss various academic and research-related matters. The members of the committee deliberated upon the agenda items in detail and the following decisions were unanimously approved:

1. The pre-submission of the Ph.D. thesis of Ms. Sarita Kumari was approved after reviewing the progress and recommendations submitted by the concerned supervisor and committee members.
2. The proposal regarding the engagement/appointment of two faculty members for conducting practical classes and tutorial classes was discussed and approved in order to ensure the smooth conduct of academic activities and effective teaching-learning process.
3. The proposal for the purchase of geographical instruments and laboratory equipment required for academic and research purposes in the department was also approved. The committee emphasized that the procurement of these instruments would strengthen practical training, field studies, and research work of the students and scholars.

The meeting concluded with a vote of thanks to the Chair and all members present for their valuable participation and cooperation.



Submission of Dissertation Report: -

Culmination of academic journey of the students of 4th Semester, Session 2022-24 and a tribute to our former Director Prof. Poornima Shekhar Singh. External Expert namely Dr. Anoop Kumar Singh and Prof Sanjay Kumar, along with Assistant Professor of School of



Geographical Studies, Aryabhatta Knowledge University, Patna, Dr. Manish Parashar oversaw the submission process.

EXTRACURRICULAR CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES:

International Women's Day: -

International Women's Day (IWD) was celebrated on March 8 at the School of Geographical Studies, Aryabhatta Knowledge University, Patna, to honour women's achievements and advocate for gender equality. The title of the theme was “आधी आबादी की पूरी हिस्सेदारी”. Students and co-workers highlighted the women's achievements in various realms, self-dependency and confidence.



International Women's Day – March 08, 2025

Bihar Diwas 2025: -

Education Department, Govt. of Bihar, assigned Patliputra University as Nodal University to organise various Cultural Programmes at Shri Krishna Memorial Hall on the occasion of Bihar Diwas 2025. Dr. Manish Parashar, Assistant Professor, School of Geographical Studies, Aryabhatta Knowledge University, Patna was the Nodal Officer of our University. Miscellaneous Cultural Programmes were held on 9th March, 2025 at the University under various categories. The elected participants performed their best at Shri Krishna Memorial Hall. Many participants of the University secured 1st, 2nd and 3rd prizes.

मिथिला चित्रकला संस्थान की छात्राएं हुई पुरस्कृत



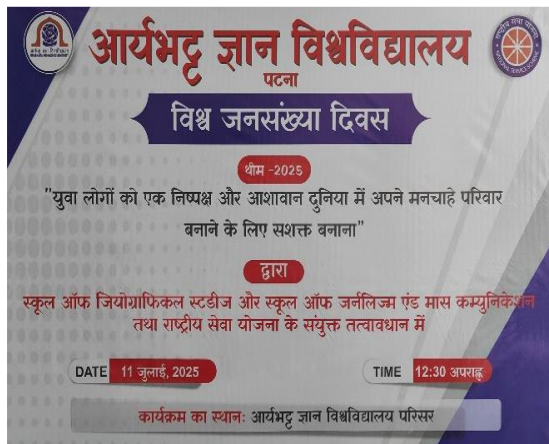
मधुबनी. बिहार दिवस पर शिक्षा विभाग की ओर से कृष्ण मेमोरियल हॉल पटना में सांस्कृतिक कार्यक्रम का आयोजन किया गया। सांस्कृतिक कार्यक्रम में मिथिला चित्रकला संस्थान की स्नातक की छात्रा मधु कुमारी ने एकल लोक-नृत्य प्रतियोगिता में द्वितीय स्थान प्राप्त किया। वहीं समूह लोक नृत्य प्रतियोगिता में स्नातक की छात्रा मधु कुमारी, अंजली कुमारी, पूजा कुमारी, मेघा झा, कुमारी प्रेमलता एवं सिद्धी कुमारी ने भाग लेकर द्वितीय स्थान प्राप्त किया। छात्राओं की समूह ने मिथिला की पारंपरिक लोक नृत्य सामा चकेबा का प्रदर्शन कर दर्शकों की खूब तालिया बटोरी। कार्यक्रम की तैयारी संस्थान के प्रभारी प्रशासी पदाधिकारी नीतीश कुमार, कनीय आचार्य प्रतीक प्रभाकर एवं डीईओ मो. जावेद आलम, विद्यार्थी दुर्गेश मंडल, सिकंदर मुखिया, अजीत कुमार, विक्की कुमार आदि ने महत्वपूर्ण भूमिका निभायी।

World Population Day 2025: -

World population Day was celebrated on 11th July 2025 to raise awareness about global population issues. The School of Geographical Studies, School of Mass Communication and National Service Scheme jointly took this opportunity to organize a one-day seminar on the theme "Population: A Boon or a Burden". The event aimed to create awareness among students and scholars about population dynamics and sustainable development.

The seminar commenced at 12:30 PM with the address of Dr. Manish Parashar, an eminent Geographer and Head of the School of Geographical Studies and the address

of Dr. Manisha Prakash, a well-known name in the field of journalism and Head of the school of Journalism and Mass communication.



14 students from M.A./MSc Geography, Session 2023-25 presented research papers on topic, such as:

- Population pressure and Urbanization
- Population as a resource
- India and its Population Power
- Population and reproductive health
- Population and Sustainable development

World Ozone Day 2025: -

The School of Geographical Studies, Aryabhatta Knowledge University, Patna, organized a Poster Competition and Vox Pop on the occasion of World Ozone Day, celebrated every year on 16th September to raise awareness about the importance of the ozone layer and the need to protect it.

The event aimed to sensitize students towards environmental conservation and to encourage creative expressions related to the protection of the ozone layer and sustainable development. Students from M.A. Geography programmes actively participated in the poster competition, preparing innovative and informative posters on themes such as *Ozone Layer Depletion*, *Sustainable Planet*, *Save Earth*, and *Climate Action*.



Training Programme on waste management:

On 08 August 2025, our school actively participated in a Training Programme for Skill Development on Waste Management organized with the objective of creating awareness and enhancing practical knowledge regarding sustainable waste management practices. Students and teachers enthusiastically took part in the programme and gained valuable insights into waste segregation, recycling, composting, and scientific disposal methods. The training emphasized the importance of environmental conservation and encouraged participants to adopt responsible waste management practices in their daily lives. The programme proved to be highly informative and beneficial in developing environmental awareness, practical skills, and a sense of social responsibility among the participants.



NATIONAL YOUTH DAY -

On the occasion of National Youth Day, celebrated on 12 January 2026, the institution organized a debate competition on the theme "Indian Youth: Prospects and Challenges." The event aimed to encourage awareness, critical thinking, and constructive discussion among students regarding the opportunities and issues faced by the youth of contemporary India. Participants actively expressed their views on employment, education, technological advancement, social responsibility, and the role of youth in nation-building. The programme witnessed enthusiastic participation from students and faculty members, making the event intellectually enriching and successful. The celebration highlighted the importance of empowering youth and inspiring them to contribute positively towards society and national development.



START-UP CONVERSATION:

On 16 April 2026, the institution organized a “Waste to Wealth” Conversation in collaboration with with the objective of promoting sustainable development, waste management practices, and innovative entrepreneurial ideas. The conference provided a platform for academicians, students, innovators, and entrepreneurs to discuss the effective utilization of waste materials for economic and environmental benefits. Various sessions highlighted the importance of recycling, resource recovery, circular economy, and start-up opportunities in the waste management sector. Participants actively engaged in discussions and shared innovative ideas aimed at transforming waste into valuable resources. The programme was highly informative and successful in creating awareness regarding environmental sustainability and entrepreneurship among the youth.



East Zone Vice Chancellors' Meet (2025-2026):

Our school proudly participated in the East Zone Vice Chancellors' Meet where the students presented an innovative "Smart Village Model." The model highlighted the concept of sustainable rural development through the integration of modern technology, renewable energy, waste management, digital education, smart agriculture, and improved rural infrastructure. The presentation reflected the creativity, scientific temperament, and social awareness of the students. The model received appreciation from academicians, dignitaries, and participants for its practical approach towards transforming villages into self-reliant and sustainable communities. The participation provided students with valuable exposure and encouraged them to contribute towards rural innovation and nation-building.



Awareness Programme on Cyber Security:

An Awareness Programme on Cyber Security was organized by the School of Journalism and Mass Communication, in which the students and faculty members of our school actively participated. The programme aimed to create awareness regarding cyber threats, online frauds, data privacy, and safe digital practices in today's technology-driven world. Experts and resource persons discussed various aspects of cyber security, including social media safety, cybercrime prevention, password protection, and responsible use of digital platforms. The session proved to be highly informative and beneficial for the participants, enhancing their understanding of digital safety and encouraging responsible online behaviour.



Conclusion:

As we conclude this annual report, we reflect on a year of resilience, adaptability, and progress. Despite challenges, our commitment to excellence has enabled us to navigate complexities and grab new opportunities. Looking ahead, we remain focused on sustainable growth, innovation, and delivering value to all. With strong foundations and a clear vision, we are confident that the coming year will bring continued success and meaningful impact.